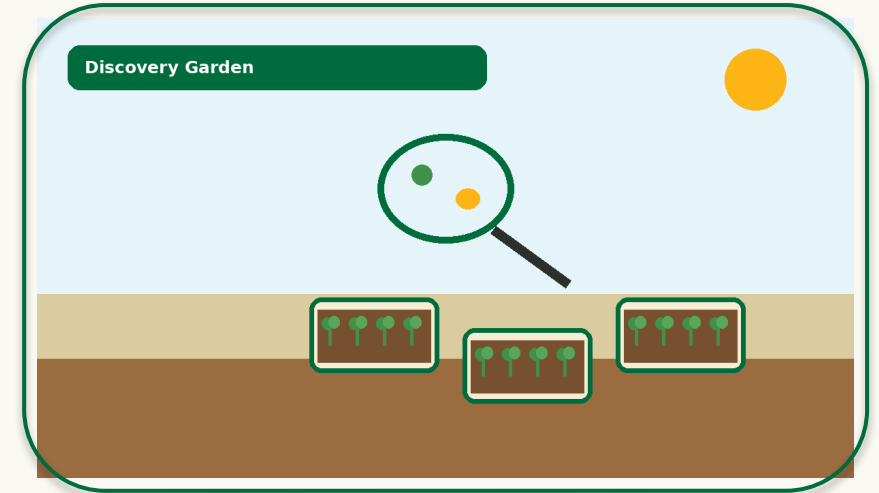


Discovery Garden

Learning Through Garden Exploration

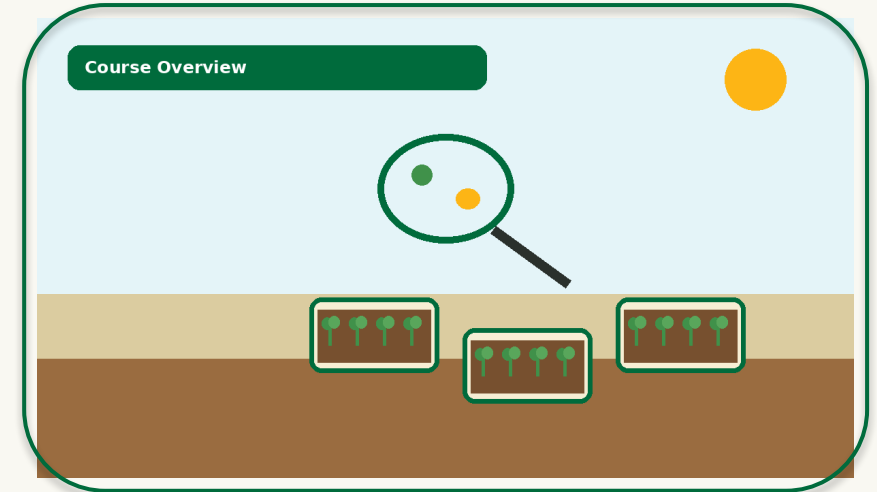
- LIFEWS AgriShine™ GrowMeal™ Nursery Teacher Training
- Audience: Nursery teachers, teaching assistants and garden facilitators
- Format: Self-paced online course + supervised practical orientation
- Recommended duration: 2 hours 30 minutes online + 60 minutes garden practical



Course Overview

Learning outcomes, materials and completion requirements

- By the end of the course, teachers should be able to explain the garden's learning purpose, prepare age-appropriate activities, facilitate the ten course topics, manage children safely outdoors, and document learning through observation.
- Recommended materials: teacher guide; picture/word cards appropriate to the garden; child-safe tools where needed; watering equipment; observation sheets; drawing materials; labels; handwashing supplies; first-aid access.
- Completion: review all modules, complete the practical teacher task, and demonstrate safe supervision of one short garden lesson.



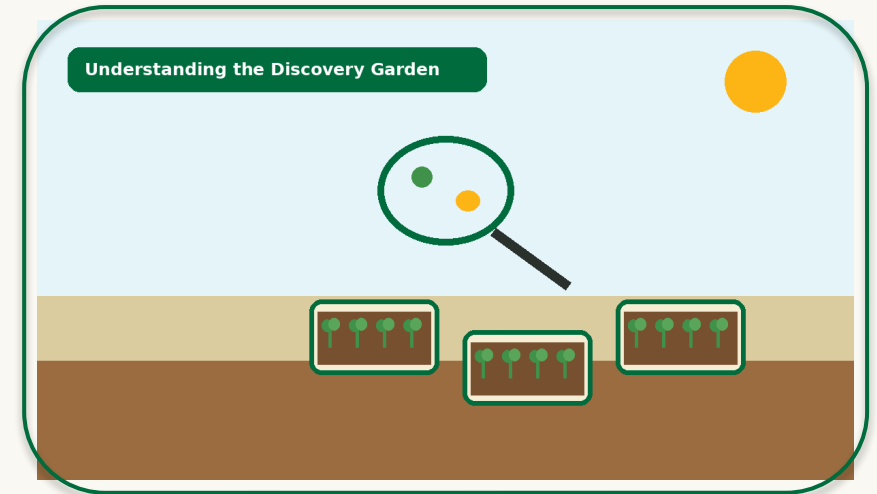
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Training principle: concrete experience first, simple language second, repetition throughout.

Understanding the Discovery Garden

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- A Discovery Garden is a structured outdoor environment for guided investigation of plants, soil, water and small garden life.
- It should encourage curiosity without becoming unstructured free play around crops and tools.
- Teachers prepare a small number of observation questions before each visit.
- Children learn by looking, describing, comparing, asking and caring.
- Teacher routine: NOTICE → WONDER → EXPLORE SAFELY → SHARE → RECORD.



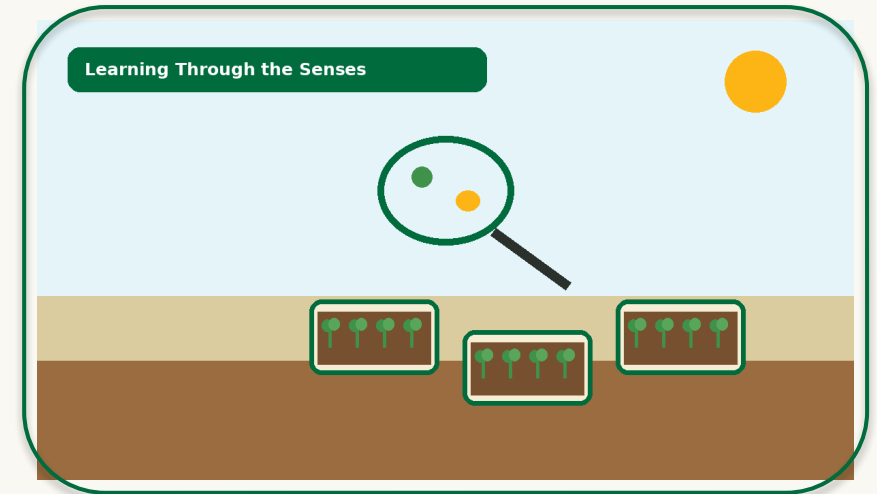
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Choose one discovery focus for each garden visit.

Learning Through the Senses

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Use sight, touch, smell and sound to notice garden features safely.
- Select materials in advance for touching and smelling.
- Never ask children to taste unknown plants or soil.
- Use sensory vocabulary and allow children to decline uncomfortable textures or smells.
- Keep sensory activities brief enough to protect living plants from overhandling.



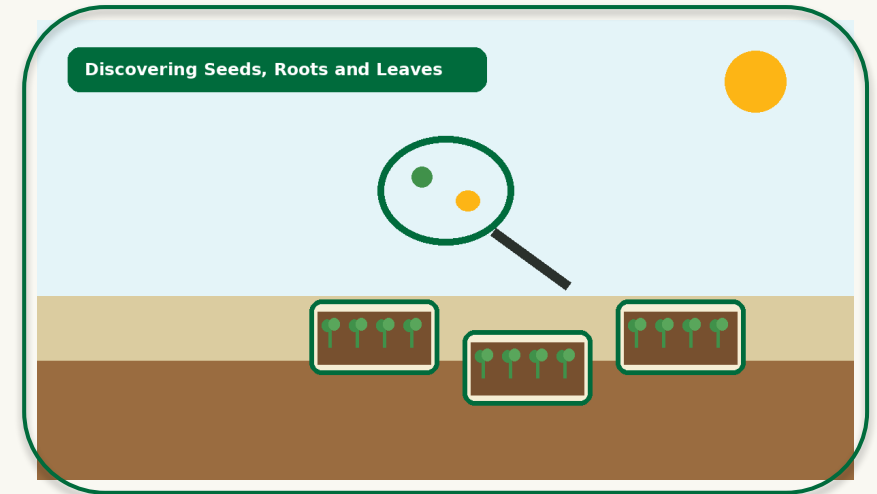
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare a four-senses observation station.

Discovering Seeds, Roots and Leaves

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Use seeds, visible leaves and teacher-prepared root examples to introduce major plant parts.
- Observe roots through approved root-view units or harvested examples rather than digging up growing plants.
- Compare seed size, leaf shape and root appearance in simple language.
- Connect parts to the whole plant.
- Use pictures when a plant part is not safely visible.



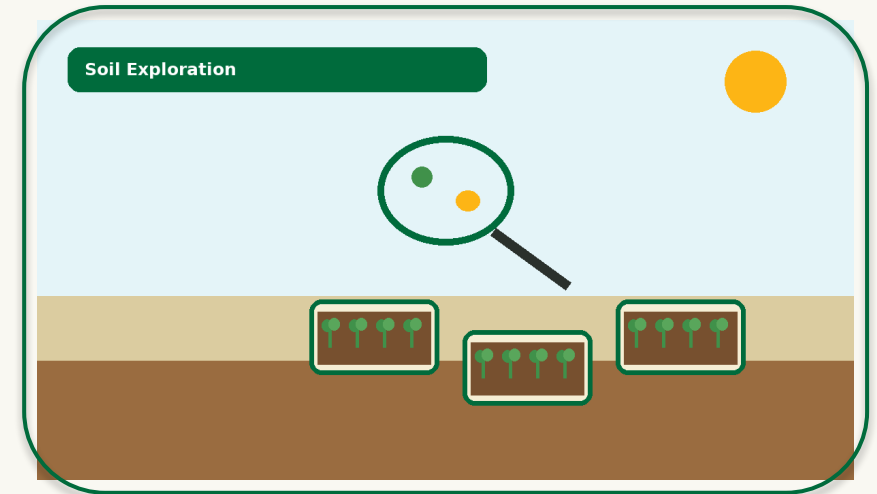
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare seed samples and one safe root-view example.

Soil Exploration

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Let children observe clean garden soil prepared for learning.
- Use words such as dry, moist, crumbly, smooth, rough, light and dark.
- Compare two safe soil/growing-media samples without making unsupported claims about quality.
- Do not allow soil throwing or tasting.
- Wash hands immediately after soil activities.



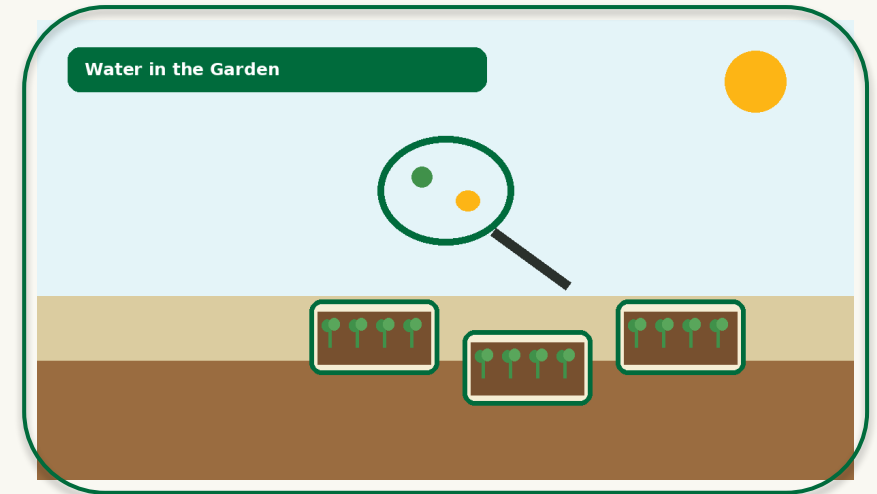
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare two trays of approved soil/growing media.

Water in the Garden

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Identify where garden water comes from and where it goes.
- Observe watering cans, drip lines or storage features from safe positions.
- Compare dry and moist growing media using teacher-prepared samples.
- Teach that plants need suitable amounts of water.
- Avoid standing-water play in production areas.



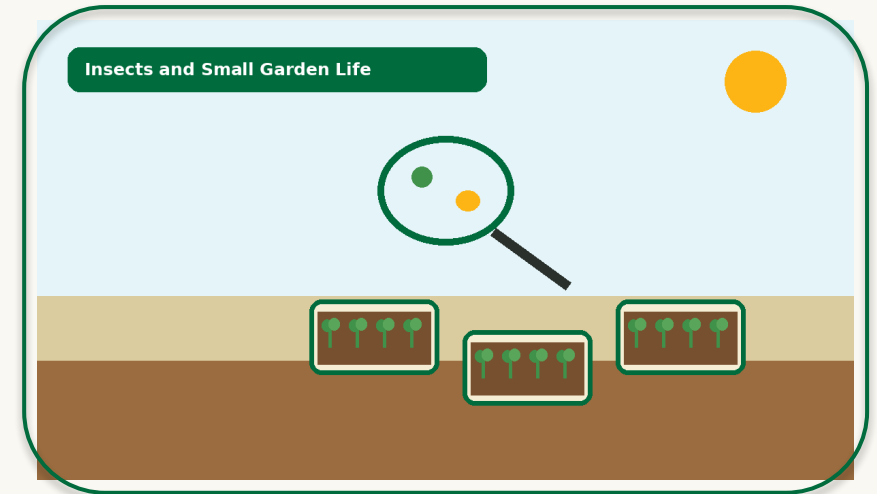
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Trace one simple water path with the class.

Insects and Small Garden Life

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Observe insects, worms and other small organisms without unnecessary handling.
- Explain that some garden organisms help plants, some feed on plants and many simply live in the environment.
- Do not label every insect as harmful.
- Use magnifying viewers only for teacher-approved temporary observation.
- Return any collected harmless organism promptly under program guidance.



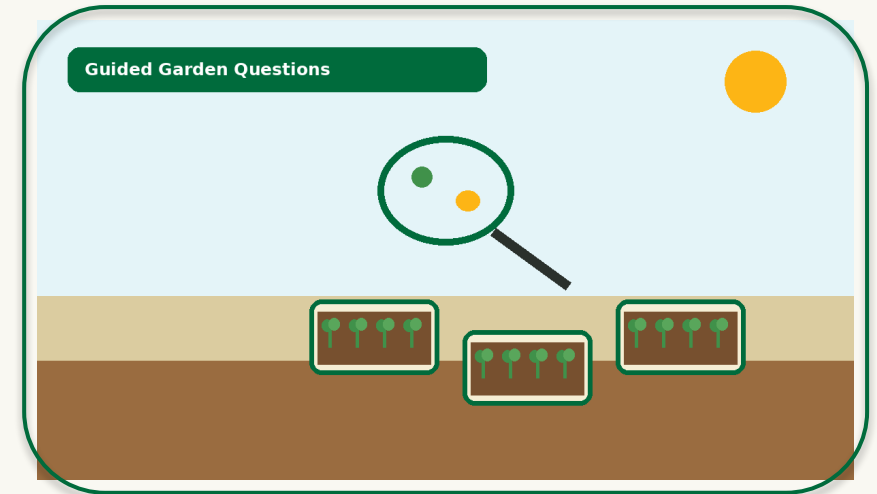
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare picture cards in case live organisms are not visible.

Guided Garden Questions

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Use questions that invite noticing: “What do you see?” “What changed?” “Which is bigger?” “Where is the water going?”
- Ask one question at a time and give children time to look.
- Follow children's observations with “What makes you think that?” in simple language.
- Avoid turning every question into a quiz with one expected answer.
- Record interesting child questions for future visits.



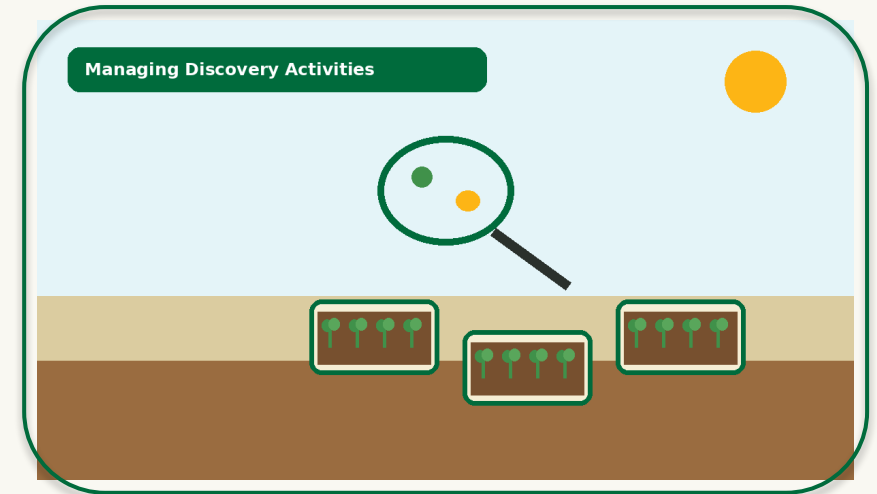
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Prepare five observation questions before the lesson.

Managing Discovery Activities

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Use small groups and clearly defined stations.
- Set boundaries before exploration begins.
- Keep tools at supervised stations rather than freely available.
- Use a visible gathering point and consistent attention signal.
- Rotate groups before one area becomes crowded or overhandled.
- Finish with sharing, handwashing and tool/material count.



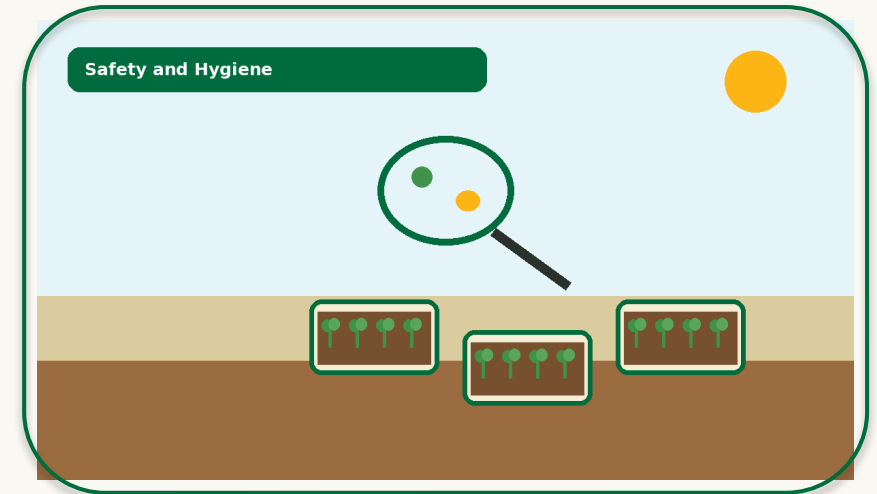
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Plan 3 stations for a 30-minute discovery lesson.

Safety and Hygiene

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Inspect the garden before each session for damaged structures, sharp objects, unsafe plants, insects, water hazards and slippery paths.
- Teach children to ask before touching or tasting anything.
- Use child-safe tools only when required.
- Follow school heat, weather, allergy, sting and first-aid procedures.
- Wash hands after soil, plants and garden organisms.
- Stop exploration immediately if conditions become unsafe.



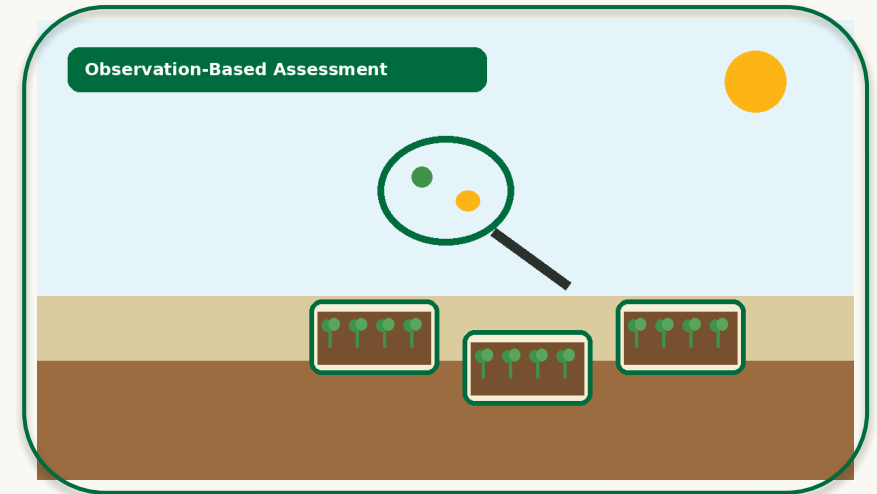
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Pre-lesson check: PEOPLE • PLACE • PLANTS • WATER • WEATHER • HYGIENE.

Observation-Based Assessment

Teacher knowledge and garden practice

- Assess what children notice, describe, compare, question and remember from repeated visits.
- Use teacher notes, drawings, photographs of learning products and short oral responses.
- Distinguish direct observation from information the teacher supplied.
- Record whether children follow safe exploration routines.
- Use children's questions to plan the next discovery experience.



TEACHER PRACTICE

- Completion task: design a 30-minute Discovery Garden investigation.